

Language Access & Digital Compliance Checklist

A plain-language guide to every compliance requirement your agency, school, or healthcare organization needs to meet in 2026.

● Title VI / EO 13166 ● Section 508 ● ADA Title II ● WCAG 2.2 ● IDEA / FERPA ● HIPAA

How to use this checklist: Each item below is a real legal requirement. Check off what you have in place. Anything unchecked is a compliance gap — and a potential liability. Use the free PDF Accessibility Checker at teamtaika.com/pdf-accessibility-checker to test your documents instantly.

SECTION 1: Language Access for People with Limited English

Required by: Title VI of the Civil Rights Act · Executive Order 13166

- ☐ We have a written Language Access Plan (LAP) that is reviewed annually.
EO 13166 requires federal fund recipients to have a documented plan.
- ☐ We identify the languages spoken in our service area (top languages by population).
Required to determine which languages need translation and interpretation.
- ☐ We provide free oral interpretation for all programs and services.
Charging for interpretation is a Title VI violation.
- ☐ We translate vital documents into languages spoken by 5%+ or 1,000+ residents.
'Vital documents' include applications, consent forms, notices of rights, and complaint forms.
- ☐ Translated documents are accurate, plain-language, and reviewed by a qualified translator.
Google Translate alone does not meet the standard for vital documents.
- ☐ Staff know how to access interpretation services (phone, video, in-person).
Frontline staff must be able to connect residents to language services immediately.
- ☐ We post 'Language Access Available' notices in common languages at service locations.
Including on your website and in waiting areas.
- ☐ We track language access requests and complaints.
Documentation demonstrates compliance and helps improve your LAP.
- ☐ Our LEP plan covers emergency communications and notifications.
Emergency alerts and evacuation instructions must reach LEP residents.

SECTION 2: Digital Accessibility for People with Disabilities

- ☐ Our website meets WCAG 2.2 Level AA standards.
New ADA Title II rule requires state/local government websites to meet WCAG 2.2 AA by April 2026.
- ☐ All PDFs we publish are tagged, have selectable text, and include alt text for images.
Untagged or scanned PDFs are inaccessible to screen readers. Use our free PDF checker to test yours.
- ☐ All online forms have labeled fields, error messages, and can be completed by keyboard.
Forms that only work with a mouse exclude users with motor disabilities.
- ☐ All videos we publish have closed captions and audio descriptions.
Required under Section 508 for any video produced or used by the agency.
- ☐ We have an accessibility policy posted on our website.
Must include a process for requesting accommodations and a way to submit complaints.
- ☐ We respond to accessibility accommodation requests within 2 business days.
Best practice is a defined SLA. ADA requires 'prompt' response — 2 days is the standard.
- ☐ We conduct annual accessibility audits of our website and digital materials.
A one-time fix is not enough — new content is added regularly and must also be compliant.
- ☐ Our procurement process requires vendors to provide accessible digital products.
Section 508 requires accessible ICT for anything purchased with federal funds.

SECTION 3: Schools & Education Agencies

Required by: IDEA · Title III of ESEA · FERPA · ADA Title II (Skip if not applicable)

- ☐ We translate IEP and 504 documents into the parent's primary language.
IDEA requires meaningful participation — parents must understand IEP meetings and documents.
- ☐ We provide qualified interpreters (not students or siblings) for parent-teacher and IEP meetings.
Using a child to interpret for their own education decisions is a federal violation.
- ☐ Our ELL/ESL program is research-based and receives adequate resources.
Title III requires 'scientifically based' language instruction programs.
- ☐ Enrollment forms and welcome packets are available in community languages.
Required under both Title VI and Title III to ensure equal access to education.
- ☐ We notify parents of LEP rights in their language at the start of each school year.
Annual notice of language services and rights is required under Title III.
- ☐ Student records requests and FERPA notices are available in family languages.
FERPA protections must be communicated in a language families can understand.

SECTION 4: Healthcare Organizations

Required by: Section 1557 of the ACA · HIPAA · Section 504 (Skip if not applicable)

- ☐ We provide qualified medical interpreters at no cost to patients.
Section 1557 prohibits charging patients for interpreter services. Bilingual staff are not sufficient without training.
- ☐ Informed consent forms are available in patients' primary languages.
Consent is not legally valid if the patient does not understand what they are signing.

- ☐ We post 'Nondiscrimination and Accessibility' notices in all languages spoken by 5%+ of our service area.
Section 1557 requires this notice in the top 15 languages in your state at minimum.
- ☐ Discharge instructions and prescription information are translated for LEP patients.
Untranslated discharge instructions lead to readmissions and are a Section 1557 risk.
- ☐ Our patient portal and digital health tools meet WCAG 2.2 AA standards.
Section 504 deadline for healthcare digital accessibility was May 2026.
- ☐ We have a grievance procedure for discrimination complaints including language access.
Required under Section 1557 for covered entities with 15 or more employees.

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